

WEST INDIES SHOWS SIGNS OF FIGHT AGAINST DOMINANT HOST

Its performance in the latter half of the second Test against India, with John Campbell and Shai Hope scoring centuries, **bodes well** for its future.

Heroics in vain:

Centurions John Campbell and Shai Hope's 177-run defiance kept India's bowlers at bay for a session and a half. AFP

Abhishek Saini

abhishek.s@thehindu.co.in

West Indies hadn't won a Test in India since 1994, and not many had lofty expectations of Roston Chase and Co. to end this unceremonious streak.

It landed in India on the back of just two wins in its last 10 Tests, having endured a demolition at the hands of Australian pacers, and losing two ace quicks — Shamar Joseph and Alzarri Joseph — to injuries.

However, this was still a side desperate for a turnaround — not in fortune, but in morale. In this context, John Campbell and Shai Hope's 177-run defiance that kept India's bowlers at bay for a session and a half during the second Test in New Delhi was akin to the West Indies turning a corner.

Captain Chase had lamented his side's propensity to fail to stick to basics for long enough and hand away advantages. Even after their heroics in the second Test, Hope and Campbell average 27 and 25, respectively, this year. **But they offered a template for turning their team's ailing form around, blending intent and attrition against a threatening spin attack.**

Lower down the order, Justin Greaves emerged as a dependable batter who could usher in the change of intent. He gave glimpses of resolve against Australia and reinforced the order with a doughty

fifty in the second innings in New Delhi. The remnants of their batting bravado were visible when West Indies took the field to defend 121 runs. With close-in catchers keeping India's batters on their toes, West Indies looked far from the listless side that had meandered through

